

of SD RAM. Recently, I have encountered a strange problem. I have a video clip in .avi format that is 341 MB—58 minutes long. When playing the file with Windows Media Player, the sound is playing, but no video is visible and the error message “Error downloading codec” flashes. Do I need to download any codec to view the video of the file (it’s a video clip, as shown by the watermark). If yes, can you give me the link to download that codec? The clip is not playing with Winamp either.

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E-mail us your computing problems, and we may answer them here! Since we get more mails per day than we can handle, it may take some time for your query to be answered. Rest assured, we are listening!

A There are several ways to compress a video into .avi format and so, there are different codecs that you will need to view all of them. To find out what codec you need for a particular movie, you can install a program called Gspot. This program tests a movie and tells you what codec is required and also whether or not you have that codec installed on your system. You can then search and download the relevant code and play your file. Alternatively, download and install VLC player, which plays most video formats. You can download these at www.headbands.com/gspot/ and www.videolan.org/vlc respectively.

OS Does Not Install

Q I have a Mercury (KOB 810e FST) motherboard with a Pentium III (Coppermine) processor, 128 MB of RAM and a 40 GB Seagate Barracuda HDD. I had four partitions with Windows 98 SE as the primary and Windows XP Professional as the secondary OS. Recently, I formatted my drive and wanted to install the same OSes as before. Windows 98SE installed fine, but in case of Windows XP Pro, it gives me the following error message during device installation: “BAD_POOL_CALLER..... ***STOP: 0 X 000000C2 (0 X 00000040, 0 X 00000000, 0 X 80000000, 0 X 00000000)”. I have not been able to install the OS, as it shuts down automatically. I tried it several times (including formatting again), but in all cases, it refuses to install properly. What is the problem?

Kunal Chowdhury

A This generally occurs due to a faulty driver or software. If you have recently installed any new drivers for your Windows 98 system, roll them back to the previous versions or contact the manufacturer for an update. If you installed any new software,



Save the Windows memory diagnostic report

uninstall that as well. If you have installed new hardware between two installs, get updated drivers for it. If none of these work, it’s probably a RAM problem. Go to www.memtest86.com or get the utility at <http://snipurl.com/500q>. Download either utility and run it.

If you continue to get errors, test your RAM module by inserting it into some other computer. If you get a similar error, you need to replace your RAM. If it works fine, you should test your RAM slot by putting the RAM chip in a different slot on your motherboard.

Spyware Again

Q I have a system with a Pentium IV 2.4 GHz original Intel motherboard, and the OS is Windows 98. After my system boots up Windows, it gives me an error stating “run.dll error loading C:\progra ~ 1\wildta ~ 1\apps\cda\cdaeng ~ 1.dll. This system cannot find the path specified.”

Rakesh Sachdeva, via e-mail

A This is a spyware infection. Download AdAware from <http://snipurl.com/1jaz>. Make sure you update the software. Run it and then remove all the infected entries it finds. Close the program and reboot into safe mode. Make sure you can see all hidden files and folders. If found, delete the following files or folders.

C:\Windows\LOVYCF.exe
C:\Windows\NAEHORUN.exe
C:\Program Files\Bearshare (folder)
C:\Windows\System\P2PNetworking (folder)
C:\Program Files\Viewpoint (folder)
C:\Windows\System\sihrncsm.exe
C:\Program Files\ARES (folder)
C:\Program Files\Evidence Wiper (folder)
C:\Program Files\Spywarekilla (folder)
Reboot, and problem solved!

Connection Hangs Repeatedly

Q Whenever I go online, after about eight to 10 minutes, data transfer stops. The problem stops after I restart the computer. But after about seven or eight minutes, the problem returns and no webpage loads. I have formatted my C: drive and the problem was solved for a few days. I connect using a dial-up connection.

Kaushik Dasgupta

A If you are using Windows XP, update your drivers and OS with the latest patches, and your problem will be solved. If you are using Windows 98, go to the MS-DOS prompt and type in “ping www.yahoo.com.” If you get an reply, simply reinstall IE.

If, however, you get a “Request Timed Out” error, you will have to reinstall your dial-up adapter. For this, go to My Computer>Control Panel>Network. In the window that opens, you will see an entry called “Dial-Up Adapter”. Remove it and reinstall. That should solve the problem. ■